Lucas Ryan

Design Engineer

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SUMMARY

Design engineer who designs in Figma and ships in production code. Four years across enterprise e-commerce, AI tools, and mission-driven organizations, now building Next.js and headless CMS sites end to end, from information architecture and content modeling to the components editors use every day. Focused on making complex systems simple for the people who use and maintain them.

EXPERIENCE

Looking Up Arts (LUA) — San Francisco, CA (Remote)
Design Engineer (Contract) *2026 – Present*

- Designing and building the organization's new site in Next.js, Tailwind CSS, and Sanity CMS, owning the work from Figma through production code.
- Architected a single Sanity CMS schema powering three surfaces, translating ambiguous business requirements into a maintainable content model.
- Designed a conditional project-template system (one template, layout and CTA logic driven by content fields), cutting time-to-publish for non-technical editors from 2 weeks to 2–3 days.
- Structured site IA around distinct Commission, Catalogue, and Projects paths to serve both civic buyers and event clients.

Realize 2050 — San Jose, CA (Remote)
Product Designer / Research Contractor *March 2025 – July 2025*

- Owned end-to-end design of an AI-powered Navigator tool, from user flows and wireframes to high-fidelity UI, translating complex, data-dense information into clear interfaces for non-technical users.
- Developed a cohesive visual system and component library used across the product and client-facing reporting assets.

Alisa Ann Ruch Burn Foundation (AARBF) — Remote
Web Designer *Jan 2024 – Jan 2025*

- Designed a fully responsive donation and event registration experience for an audience that was 70% mobile, applying mobile-first principles to emotionally sensitive flows.
- Applied accessibility-first design throughout, simplifying navigation and improving readability across device sizes with non-technical stakeholders.

Thermo Fisher Scientific — Carlsbad, CA (Remote)
UX Design Intern → Junior UX Designer *Sept 2021 – Sept 2023*

- Redesigned responsive e-commerce flows, including browse, search, and checkout, for desktop and mobile users, improving navigation clarity.
- Built and maintained reusable UI components within the internal design system, keeping a large, multi-team product visually and functionally consistent.
- Ran usability testing and synthesized findings to validate design decisions and prioritize iterations.

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego — La Jolla, CA
B.S. Cognitive Science, Design & Interaction *2017 – 2022*

- Teaching Assistant for DSGN 100: led prototyping workshops and mentored student design teams.

SKILLS

Engineering: Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS, Sanity CMS, HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, Git
Design: Information Architecture, Content Modeling, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Accessibility (WCAG)
Tools: Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Jira